

Data Modelling and Form Design for a Business Application in Zoho Creator

Hotel Room Booking Form - Basic Fields Use Case

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Aim

To design and build a functional Hotel Room Booking Form in Zoho Creator that demonstrates the correct use of all thirteen Basic Fields available in the Form Builder, while providing a structured method for collecting and pre-processing guest room booking requests.

Problem Statement

Abudget hotel currently accepts room bookings through phone calls and third-party messaging apps. This process is slow, leads to double bookings, causes special requests to be missed, and gives the front desk no structured way to know guest count, room preferences, or arrival schedule in advance. The front office has no digital record of a booking until the guest actually checks in.

The proposed low-code application replaces this manual process with a single online booking form. The form captures guest identity, contact details, identification details, room and stay preferences, amenities required, scheduling information, and acknowledgement of hotel policies in a structured format.

Procedure

- Log into Zoho Creator and create a new application titled “Hotel Room Booking & Front Office Management”.
- Create a form named “Room_Booking_Form” and arrange the fields into four logical sections: Guest Details, Contact Details, Room & Stay Preferences, and Scheduling & Policy Acknowledgement.
- Add all thirteen Basic Fields specified in the use case: Name, Email, Address, Phone, Single Line, Multi Line, Number, Date, Time, Drop Down, Radio, Multi Select, and Checkbox.
- Set the field link names and configure the appropriate choices for Room Type, Meal Plan, and Amenities Required.
- Configure the required validations: mandatory Guest Name, Phone, ID Proof Number, Number of Guests, Room Type, Check-In Date and Policy Checkbox; email format validation; Indian phone-number format; Number of Guests restricted to 1–6 per room; Check-In Date restricted to disallow past dates; and a checked policy acknowledgement before submission.
- Preview the live form, enter sample booking details, and submit the record.
- Open the Room_Booking_Form Report and verify that the submitted booking record has been stored correctly.

Data Model

The application uses one main form, Room_Booking_Form, which stores each guest booking request as a structured record. Each submitted record contains the guest's identity, contact details, identification details, room and meal preferences, amenities required, special requests, scheduling details, and policy acknowledgement. The corresponding report, Room_Booking_Report, is used by the front office to filter, confirm availability, and prepare rooms ahead of guest arrival.

Form Structure

Section	Key Fields	Purpose
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Guest Details	Guest Name, ID Proof Number, Number of Guests	Captures the guest's identity and party size for the stay.
Contact Details	Email Address, Contact Number, Permanent Address	Stores contact information for booking confirmation and billing.
Room & Stay Preferences	Room Type, Meal Plan, Amenities Required, Special Requests	Captures room category, meal selection, and additional amenities requested.
Scheduling & Policy Acknowledgement	Check-In Date, Preferred Check-in Time, Agree to Hotel Policies	Captures the guest's arrival schedule and acknowledgement of hotel policies.

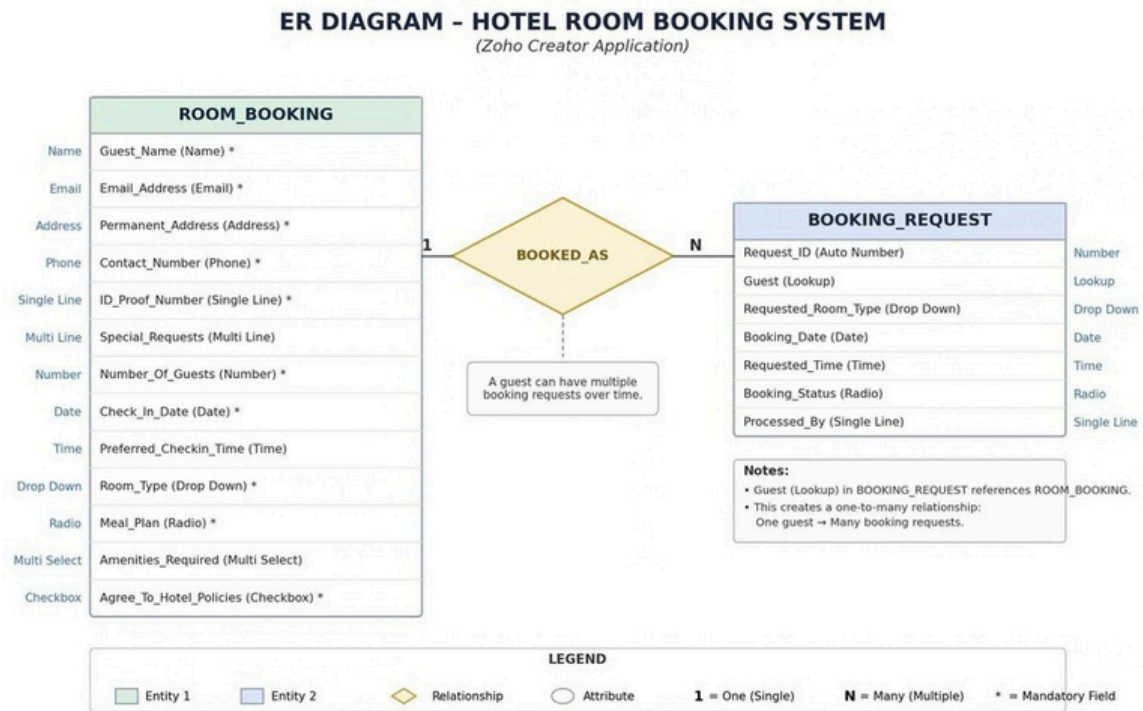


Fig. 1 – Entity-Relationship diagram for the Hotel Room Booking system, showing the ROOM_BOOKING entity (all thirteen Basic Fields) and the related BOOKING_REQUEST entity.

Basic Fields and Their Mapping

The table below maps every Basic Field required by the use case to its field name, purpose, and sample value.

Basic Field	Form Field Name	Purpose	Sample Value
Name	Guest_Name	Captures the full name of the guest using First/Last name sub-fields.	Anitha Selvam
Email	Email_Address	Captures a validated email address for sending the booking confirmation.	anitha.selvam@example.com
Address	Permanent_Address	Captures the guest's permanent residential address for records and billing.	31, Park Road, Coimbatore, TN, 641002
Phone	Contact_Number	Captures a validated mobile number for the front desk to confirm and coordinate the booking.	+91 99000 44556
Single Line	ID_Proof_Number	Captures a short free-text entry for the guest's identification document number.	Aadhaar: 1234 5678 9012
Multi Line	Special_Requests	Captures free-text remarks for any special requirements during the stay.	Requesting a room on a higher floor, away from the elevator, with an early check-in if possible.
Number	Number_Of_Guests	Captures a numeric value with validation for the total number of guests staying.	3
Date	Check_In_Date	Captures the guest's intended check-in date using a date picker.	02-Aug-2026
Time	Preferred_Checkin_Time	Captures the guest's expected arrival time at the hotel.	1:00 PM
Drop Down	Room_Type	Presents a single-select list of room categories available at the hotel.	Deluxe Double Room
Radio	Meal_Plan	Captures a single mandatory selection among mutually exclusive meal plan options.	Breakfast Included
Multi Select	Amenities_Required	Allows selection of one or more additional amenities requested for the stay.	Extra Bed, Airport Pickup, Late Checkout
Checkbox	Agree_To_Hotel_Policies	Captures the guest's acknowledgement of the hotel's check-in/check-out and cancellation policies.	Checked (Agreed)

Explanation of Screenshots

The following screenshots illustrate the workflow used to configure the Basic Fields in the Zoho Creator Form Builder and to review the corresponding report layout for the Room Booking application.

1. Room & Stay Preferences — Form Builder View

This screenshot shows the Design tab of the Room_Booking_Form with the “Room & Stay Preferences” section selected in the left-hand navigation. The centre panel displays the Room Type (Drop Down), Meal Plan (Radio: Room Only / Breakfast Included / All Meals Included), Amenities Required (Multi Select), and Special Requests (Multi Line) fields laid out on the canvas, with an “Open Form Builder” shortcut to edit field properties. The right-hand “Form Customization – Web” panel shows the available Label Placement layouts that control how field labels align relative to their input controls.

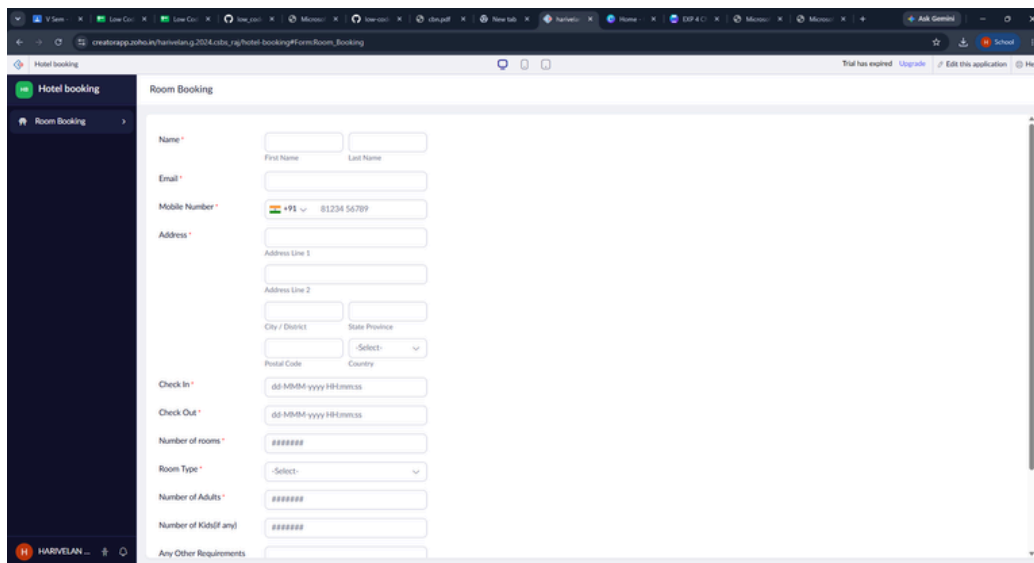


Fig. 2 – Zoho Creator Form Builder: Room & Stay Preferences section with Label Placement customization panel.

2. Room & Stay Preferences Report — Layout Customization

This screenshot shows the Design tab for the Room_Booking_Report (Room & Stay Preferences Report view). The centre grid lists the Room Type, Meal Plan, Amenities Required, and Special Requests columns that will be visible to the front office when reviewing submitted bookings. The right-hand “Report Customization – Web” panel shows the Quick View / Detail View tabs and the selectable Layout templates, along with the option to create a Custom Layout for the report.

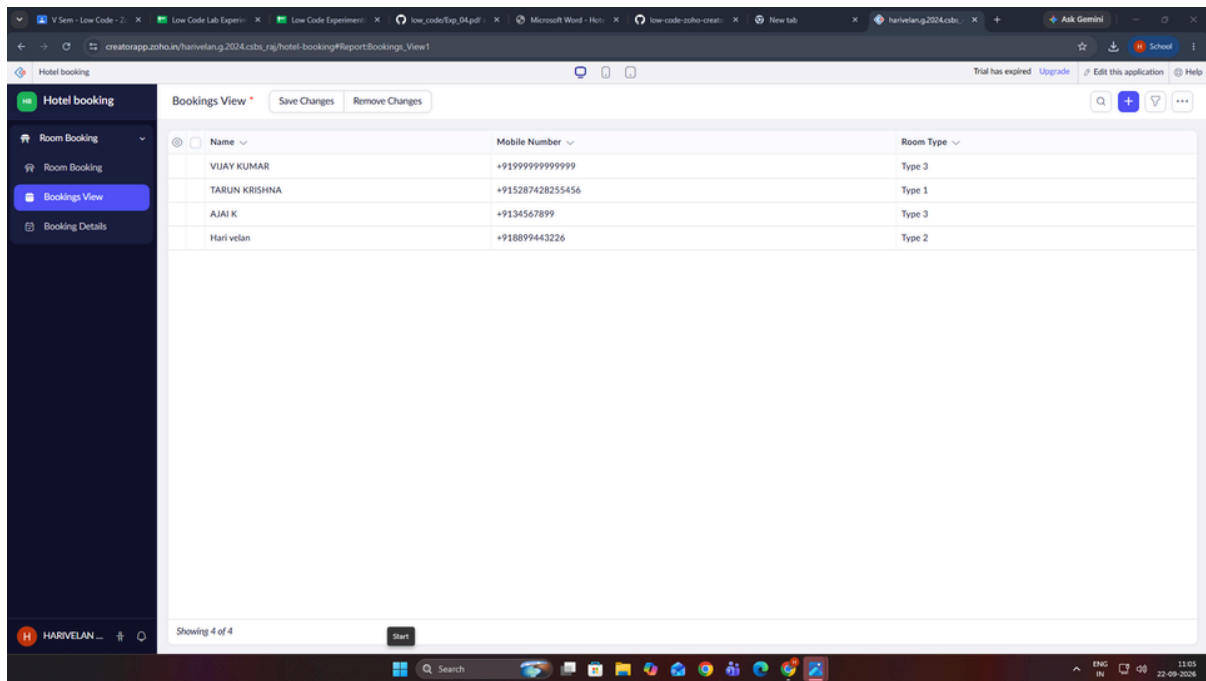


Fig. 3 – Zoho Creator Report Builder: Layout customization options for the Room & Stay Preferences Report.

3. Scheduling & Policy Acknowledgement – Section Navigation

This screenshot shows the left-hand navigation expanded to the “Scheduling & Policy Acknowledgement” section, listing its form and report sub-items alongside the Room & Stay Preferences Report grid. This confirms that the application is organised into the four logical sections described in the Form Structure table, each with its own form and report view.

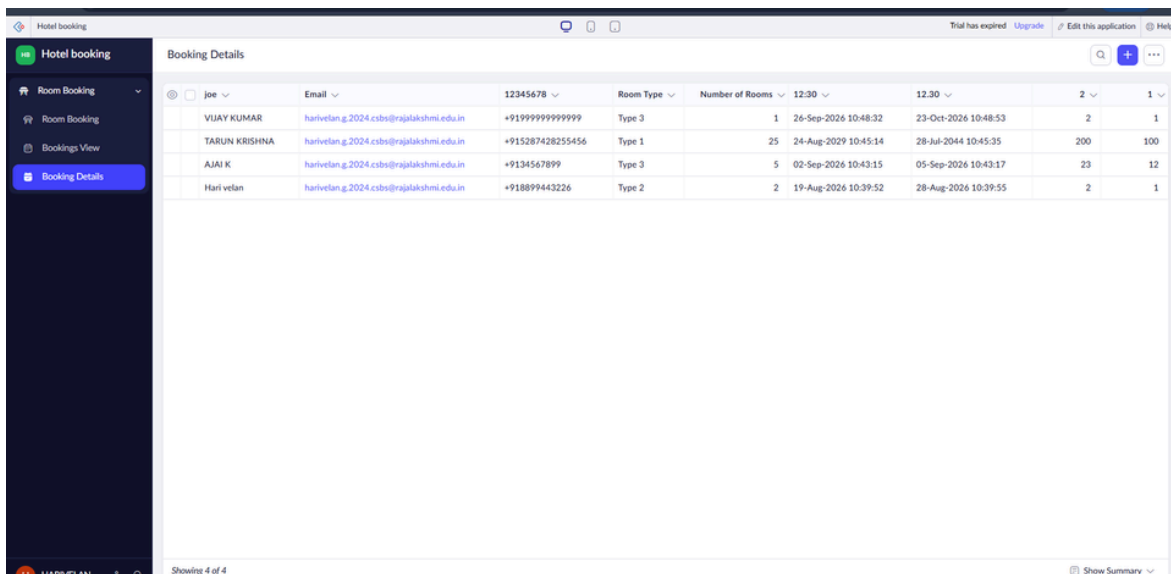


Fig. 4 – Zoho Creator navigation panel showing the Scheduling & Policy Acknowledgement section alongside the report view.

Result

The Hotel Room Booking Form was successfully designed and implemented in Zoho Creator using all thirteen required Basic Fields. The form was organised into four sections to capture guest details, contact information, room and stay preferences, and scheduling and policy acknowledgement. Appropriate

validations were configured, and the Room_Booking_Report was verified to display the submitted booking's key values, demonstrating a functional digital hotel room booking system.